Sound Transit Operations
March 2016 Service Performance Report

Ridership

Total Boardings by Mode						
Mode	**Mar-15**	**Mar-16**	**% Δ**	**YTD-15**	**YTD-16**	**% Δ**
ST Express	1,561,204	1,581,793	1.3%	4,418,234	4,465,939	1.1%
Sounder	310,952	365,505	17.5%	901,372	1,036,770	15.0%
Tacoma Link	87,937	82,631	-6.0%	256,949	244,368	-4.9%
Link	837,277	1,259,454	50.4%	2,424,996	3,072,131	26.7%
Paratransit	4,156	3,821	-8.1%	12,641	11,084	-12.3%
System Total	**2,801,526**	**3,293,204**	**17.6%**	**8,014,193**	**8,830,292**	**10.2%**

Monthly ridership figures are preliminary and subject to revision on a quarterly basis.

March 2015:	22 Weekdays	4 Saturdays	5 Sundays
March 2016:	23 Weekdays	4 Saturdays	4 Sundays

Total Sound Transit ridership increased by 491K, or 17.6%, compared to March 2015. The opening of the University Link extension drove significant increases in system-wide average weekday, Saturday, and Sunday boardings.

ST Express ridership increased by 20K, or 1.3%, and average weekday boardings decreased slightly by 1.1%. At the route level, Route 550 (Bellevue-Seattle), Route 540 (Kirkland-U District), and Route 532 (Everett-Bellevue) showed the most growth in average weekday ridership, with increases of 2%, 14%, and 7%, respectively.

Sounder monthly ridership increased 54K, or 17.5%, compared to the same period last year, while average weekday boardings increased 12.8%. Both the South Line and North Line showed strong ridership growth in March, with average weekday boarding increases of 16.4% and 12.4%, respectively.

Tacoma Link ridership decreased by 5K, or 6.0%, compared to March 2015. Saturday ridership showed a sharp decline due to a popular music concert in March 2015. In addition, a protest in Downtown Tacoma shut down service in both directions for over an hour, resulting in 13 missed trips.

Link ridership increased by 422K, or 50.4%, compared to the same period last year. Similarly, average weekday, average Saturday, and average Sunday boardings were up 43.0%, 80.7%, and 58.5%, respectively. The significant growth in March ridership is primarily due to the opening of the University Link extension on Saturday, March 19, providing light rail service to the Capitol Hill and University of Washington Stations.

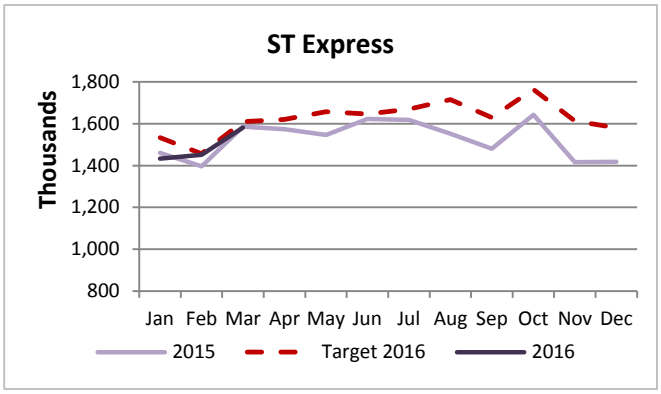
Paratransit services decreased 8.1% compared to March 2015, driven by changes in eligibility implemented in 2015.

Average Daily Boardings									
Mode	**Weekday**			**Saturday**			**Sunday**		
	Mar-15	**Mar-16**	**% Δ**	**Mar-15**	**Mar-16**	**% Δ**	**Mar-15**	**Mar-16**	**% Δ**
ST Express	63,086	62,423	-1.1%	22,685	21,549	-5.0%	15,515	14,966	-3.5%
Sounder	14,255	16,076	12.8%	-	1,619	N/A	1,326	1,834	38.3%
Tacoma Link	3,320	3,159	-4.8%	2,795	1,836	-34.3%	742	656	-11.6%
Link	30,329	43,364	43.0%	21,572	38,974	80.7%	16,751	26,547	58.5%
Paratransit	134	123	-8.1%	134	123	-8.1%	134	123	-8.1%
System Total	**111,124**	**125,146**	**12.6%**						

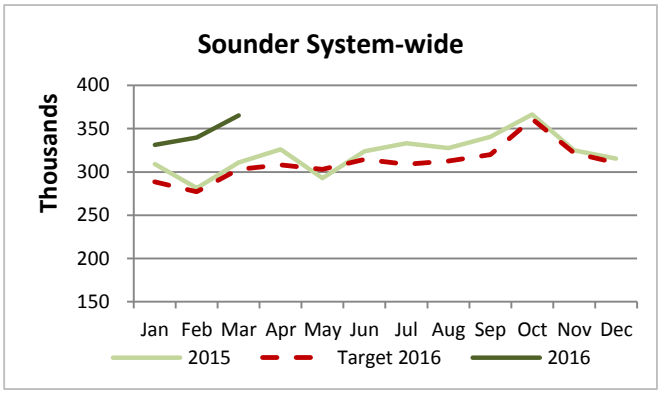
Paratransit daily boardings are assumed equal between weekdays, Saturdays, and Sundays.

Sound Transit Union Station 401 S. Jackson St., Seattle, WA 98104
1-800-201-4900 TTY Relay: 711 main@soundtransit.org www.soundtransit.org

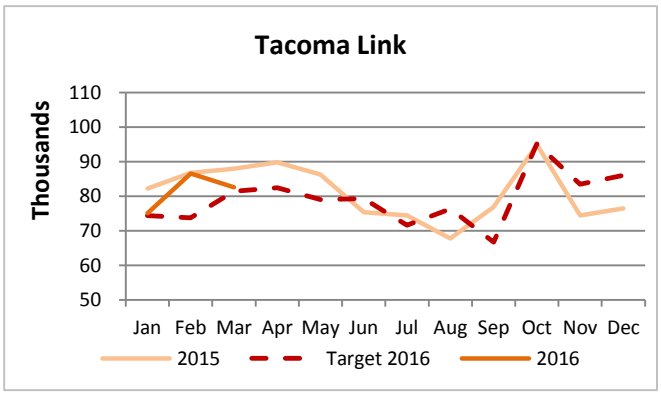
Monthly Ridership Trends by Mode



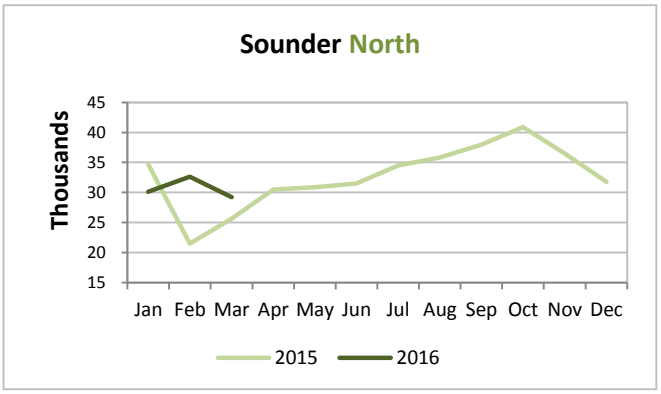
ST Express ridership increased 1.3% compared to March 2015, and average weekday boardings decreased by 1.1%.



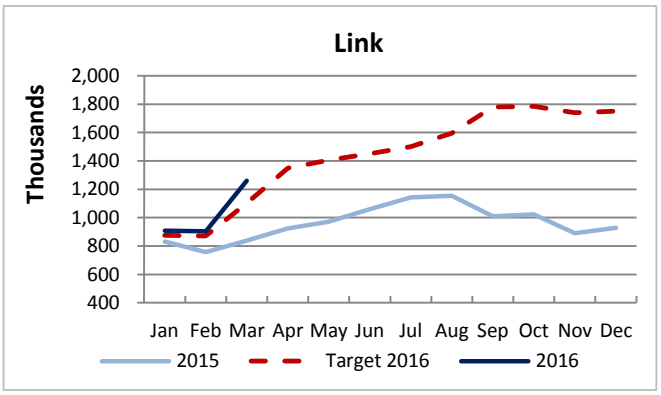
Sounder system-wide ridership increased by 17.5% compared to March 2015, and average weekday boardings increased by 12.8%.



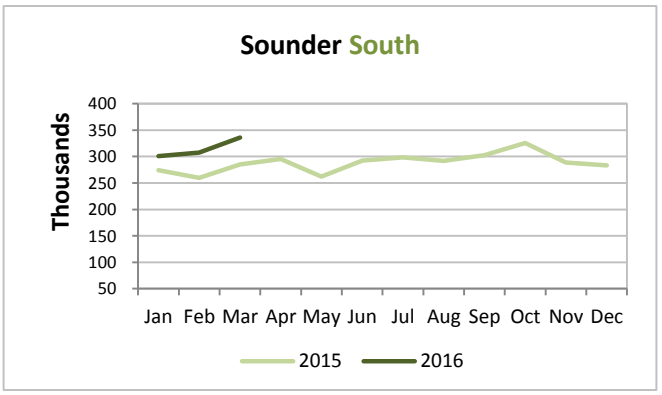
Tacoma Link ridership was down 6.0% compared to March 2015, and average weekday boardings decreased by 4.8%.



Sounder North ridership was up 13.8% compared to March 2015, due in part to an extra weekday, and higher event and commuter boardings. There were five days of cancelled trips due to mudslides, compared to three days in March 2015.



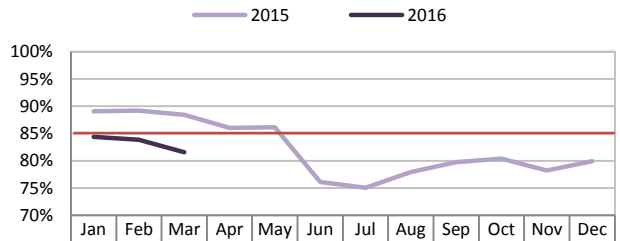
Link ridership was up 50.4% compared to March 2015, and average weekday boardings increased by 43.0%. This is due primarily to the start of University Link revenue service in March.



Sounder South ridership grew by 17.9% compared to March 2015. In addition to ongoing ridership increases, there was one more weekday in March 2016.

ST Express

On-Time Performance

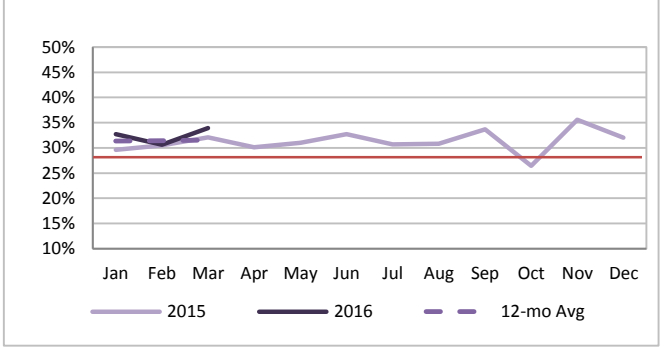


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	89.1	89.2	88.4	86.0	86.2	76.1	75.1	77.9	79.7	80.4	78.2	79.9
2016	84.4	83.9	81.5									

Target: 85% **March 2016: 81.5%** **YTD 2016: 83.3%**

OTP declined in March due to traffic congestion and overcrowding that caused late buses. We expect to see greater improvement as hours are added to alleviate these impacts.

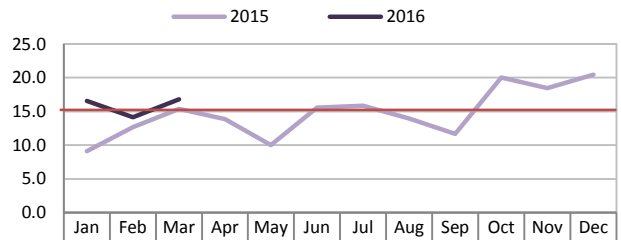
Farebox Recovery



Target: 28.4% **March 2016: 33.9%** **12-Mo Avg: 31.5%**

Farebox recovery was up more than 2% compared to March 2015. Over the most recent rolling 12-month period, ST Express has performed better than target, at 31.5% farebox recovery.

Complaints per 100K Boardings

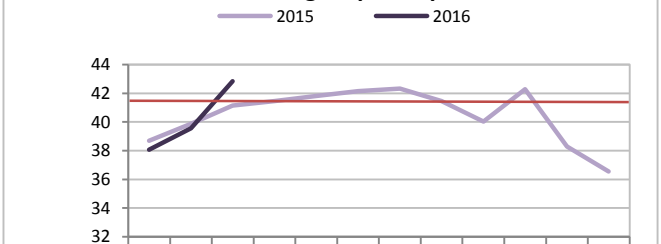


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	9.1	12.7	15.4	13.9	10.0	15.6	15.9	14.0	11.7	20.0	18.4	20.4
2016	16.5	14.1	16.8									

Target: <15 **March 2016: 16.8** **YTD 2016: 15.8**

Complaints have been up since last fall due to overcrowding and congestion. We expect to see improvement as additional hours are added to mitigate the issues.

Passengers per Trip

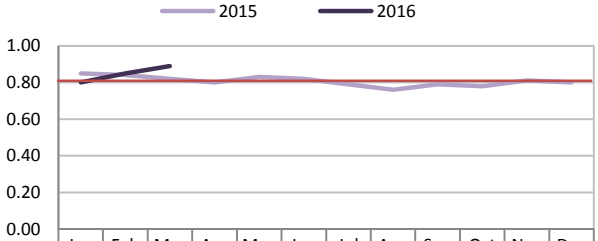


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	38.7	39.9	41.1	41.5	41.8	42.2	42.3	41.5	40.0	42.3	38.3	36.5
2016	38.1	39.6	42.8									

Target: 41.8 **March 2016: 42.8** **YTD 2016: 38.3**

March passengers per trip rose 4% higher than the same period of 2015. ST Express is still below target for YTD, but we expect the gap to disappear as the year progresses.

Preventable Accidents per 100K Miles

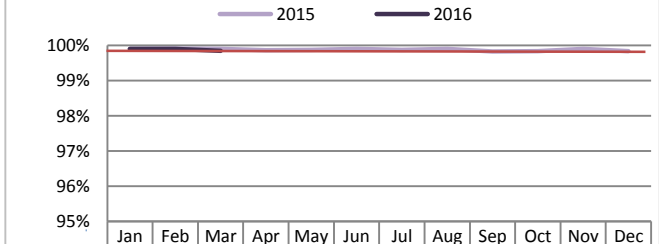


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	0.85	0.84	0.82	0.80	0.83	0.82	0.79	0.76	0.79	0.78	0.81	0.80
2016	0.80	0.85	0.89									

Target: 0.80 **March 2016: 0.89** **YTD 2016: 0.89**

ST Express operated outside the target for preventable accidents in March. While most have been minor, staff and partners are focused on identifying issues and implementing safe solutions.

Percentage of Scheduled Trips Operated



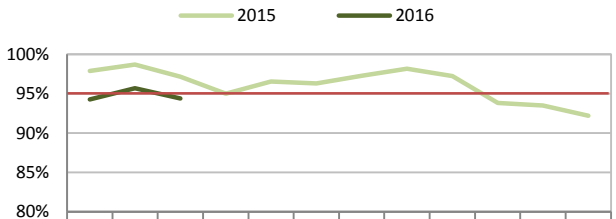
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	99.9	99.9	99.9	99.9	99.9	99.9	99.9	99.9	99.8	99.8	99.9	99.8
2016	99.9	99.9	99.9									

Target: 99.8% **March 2016: 99.9%** **YTD 2016: 99.9%**

ST Express consistently operates within the targeted range for the percentage of scheduled trips operated.

Sounder Commuter Rail

On-Time Performance

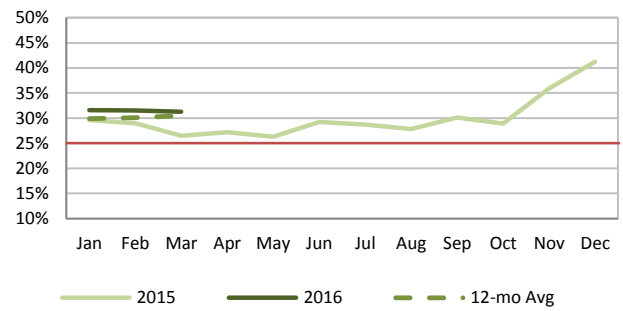


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	97.9	98.7	97.2	95.0	96.6	96.3	97.3	98.2	97.2	93.8	93.5	92.2
2016	94.3	95.7	94.4									

Target: 95.0% **March 2016: 94.4%** **YTD 2016: 94.8%**

Sounder OTP was 94.4% in March, just shy of the target, due largely to slow orders from high winds. Other delays included freight interference, mechanical issues, and other minor impacts.

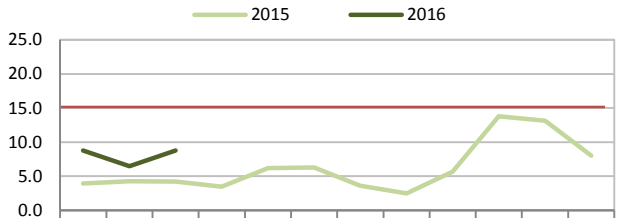
Farebox Recovery



Target: 25.3% **March 2016: 31.3%** **12-Mo Avg: 30.5%**

Farebox recovery increased nearly 5% compared to March 2015. Over the most recent rolling 12-month period, Sounder has performed better than target, at 30.5% farebox recovery.

Complaints per 100K Boardings

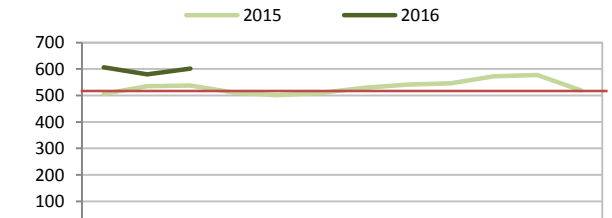


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	3.9	4.3	4.2	3.5	6.2	6.3	3.6	2.5	5.6	13.8	13.1	8.0
2016	8.8	6.5	8.8									

Target: <15 **March 2016: 8.8** **YTD 2016: 8.0**

Complaints doubled compared to March 2015, due to a combination of delays, cancellations due to mudslides, and parking constraints.

Passengers per Trip

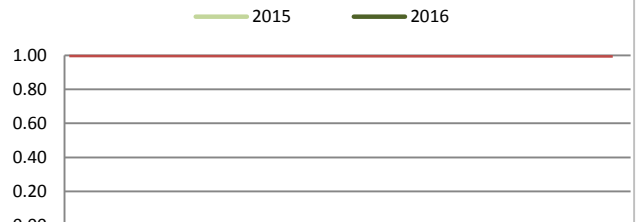


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	506.	534.	537.	511.	501.	510.	528.	540.	545.	573.	577.	519.
2016	606.	580.	601.									

Target: 507 **March 2016: 601.2** **YTD 2016: 596.0**

The number of passengers per trip increased 8% compared to March 2015, as Sounder continued to experience ridership growth.

Preventable Accidents per 100K Miles

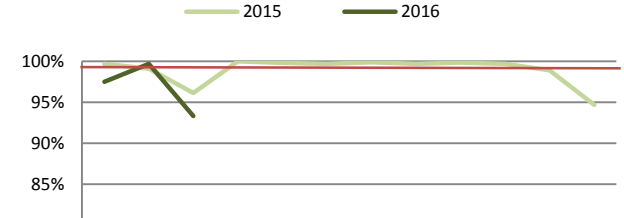


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
2016	0.00	0.00	0.00									

Target: 1.00 **March 2016: 0.00** **YTD 2016: 0.00**

Sounder has not experienced a preventable accident since service began.

Percentage of Scheduled Trips Operated



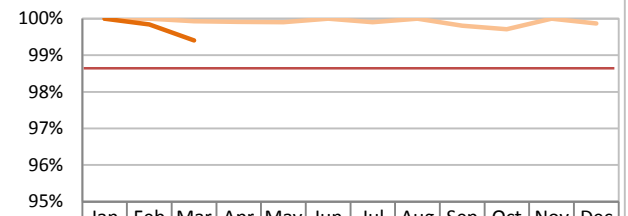
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	99.7	99.1	96.1	100.	99.8	99.7	99.9	99.7	99.8	99.7	98.9	94.7
2016	97.5	99.7	93.3									

Target: 99.5% **March 2016: 93.3%** **YTD 2016: 96.8%**

Sounder experienced five days of mudslide closures in March, compared to three days in March 2015, which drove performance below target for the percentage of scheduled trips operated.

Tacoma Link

On-Time Performance



	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	100	100	99.9	99.9	99.9	100	99.9	100	99.8	99.7	100	99.9
2016	100	99.8	99.4									

Target: 98.5% **March 2016: 99.4%** **YTD 2016: 99.7%**

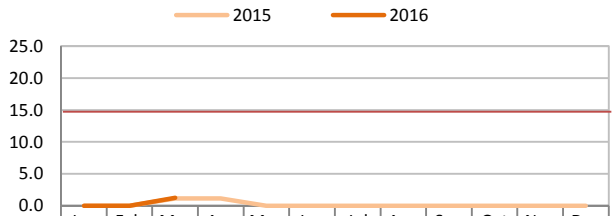
Tacoma Link consistently performs well above the target for on-time performance. Delays in March were due to a protest in downtown Tacoma.

Farebox Recovery

Tacoma Link to remain fare-free until 2022.

Per Board action in April 2016, Tacoma Link fares will not be implemented until the opening of the Hilltop extension.

Complaints per 100K Boardings

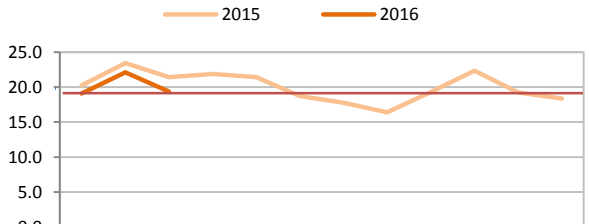


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	0.0	0.0	1.1	1.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
2016	0.0	0.0	1.2									

Target: <15 **March 2016: 1.2** **YTD 2016: 0.4**

Tacoma Link received one complaint in March. It was the first complaint received for Tacoma Link service since April 2015.

Passengers per Trip



	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	20.2	23.4	21.4	21.9	21.4	18.7	17.8	16.4	19.3	22.4	19.2	18.4
2016	19.1	22.1	19.4									

Target: 19.2 **March 2016: 19.4** **YTD 2016: 20.2**

Tacoma Link met the target for passengers per trip in March but came in 9% below 2015 results, primarily due to reduced special event boardings, and to a lesser degree, fewer weekday riders.

Preventable Accidents per 100K Miles

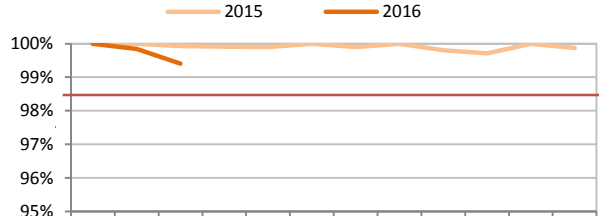


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
2016	0.00	0.00	0.00									

Target: 1.66 **March 2016: 0.00** **YTD 2016: 0.00**

Tacoma Link has not experienced any preventable accidents since March 2013.

Percentage of Scheduled Trips Operated



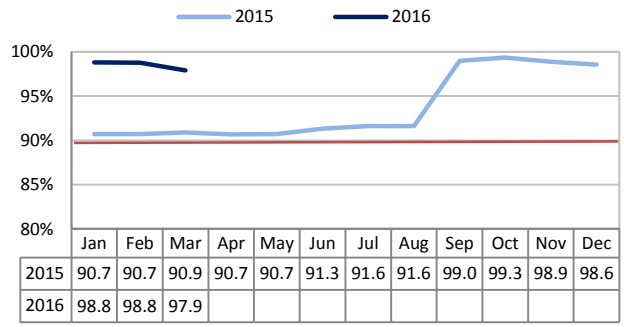
	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	100	100	99.9	99.9	99.9	100	100	100	99.8	99.7	100	99.9
2016	100	99.8	99.4									

Target: 98.5% **March 2016: 99.4%** **YTD 2016: 99.7%**

Tacoma Link consistently operates nearly all scheduled trips and performs better than the target. However, a protest in downtown Tacoma stopped service and resulted in 13 missed trips.

Link

Headway Management Performance

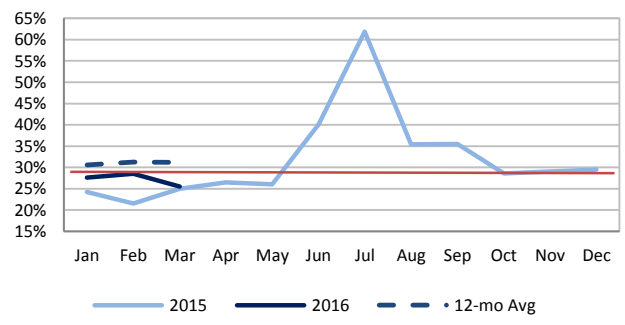


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	90.7	90.7	90.9	90.7	90.7	91.3	91.6	91.6	99.0	99.3	98.9	98.6
2016	98.8	98.8	97.9									

Target: 90% **March 2016: 97.9%** **YTD 2016: 98.5%**

The Arinc SCADA system reads more time points, generates more data, and delivers a clearer representation of Link Headway Performance than what was available prior to September 2015.

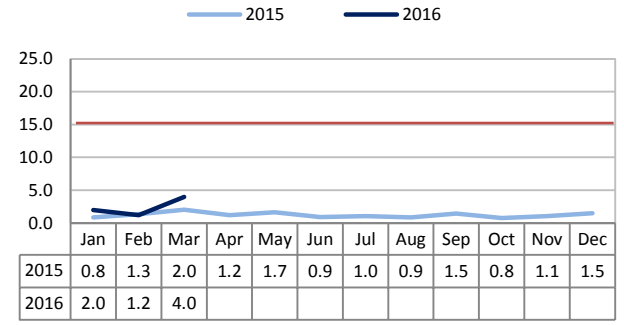
Farebox Recovery



Target: 28.5% **March 2016: 25.5%** **12-Mo Avg: 31.1%**

Farebox recovery was up by 0.5% compared to last year, but fell short of the annual target. Over the most recent rolling 12-month period, however, Link has performed better than target, at 31.1%.

Complaints per 100K Boardings

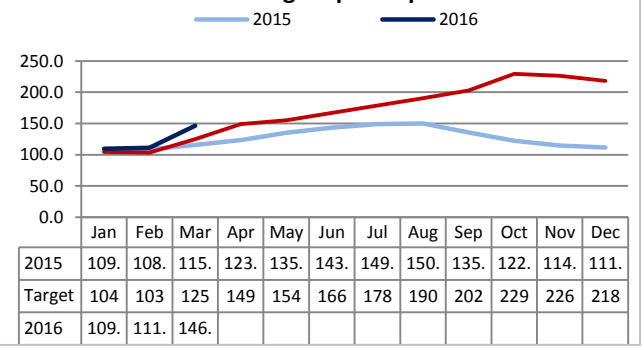


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	0.8	1.3	2.0	1.2	1.7	0.9	1.0	0.9	1.5	0.8	1.1	1.5
2016	2.0	1.2	4.0									

Target: <15 **March 2016: 4.0** **YTD 2016: 2.4**

Link experienced 4.0 complaints per 100K boardings in March, due primarily to overcrowding complaints received following the opening of University Link revenue service.

Passengers per Trip

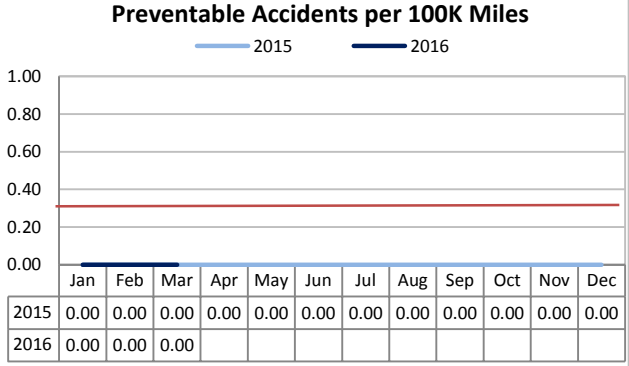


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	109.	108.	115.	123.	135.	143.	149.	150.	135.	122.	114.	111.
Target	104	103	125	149	154	166	178	190	202	229	226	218
2016	109.	111.	146.									

Target: 125.7 **March 2016: 146.4** **YTD 2016: 122.3**

Passengers per trip surpassed both March 2015 results and the March 2016 goal. The target line for passengers per trip (red) reflects the opening of U Link and Angle Lake services in 2016.

Preventable Accidents per 100K Miles

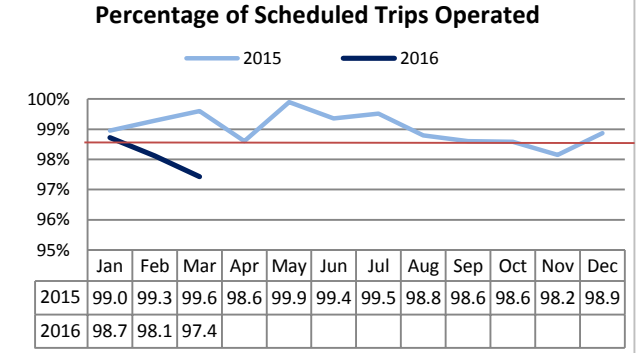


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00	0.00
2016	0.00	0.00	0.00									

Target: 0.30 **March 2016: 0.00** **YTD 2016: 0.00**

Link has not experienced any preventable accidents since July 2013.

Percentage of Scheduled Trips Operated

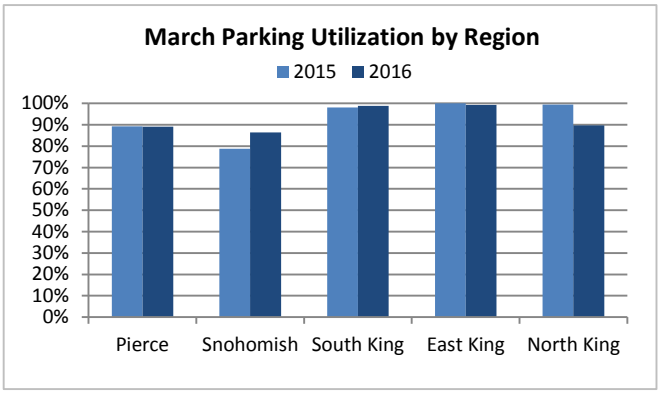


	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
2015	99.0	99.3	99.6	98.6	99.9	99.4	99.5	98.8	98.6	98.6	98.2	98.9
2016	98.7	98.1	97.4									

Target: 98.5% **March 2016: 97.4%** **YTD 2016: 98.1%**

Link fell slightly below target in March due, in part, to two unrelated vehicle accidents that disrupted service, and two mechanical failures that required towing.

General Transit

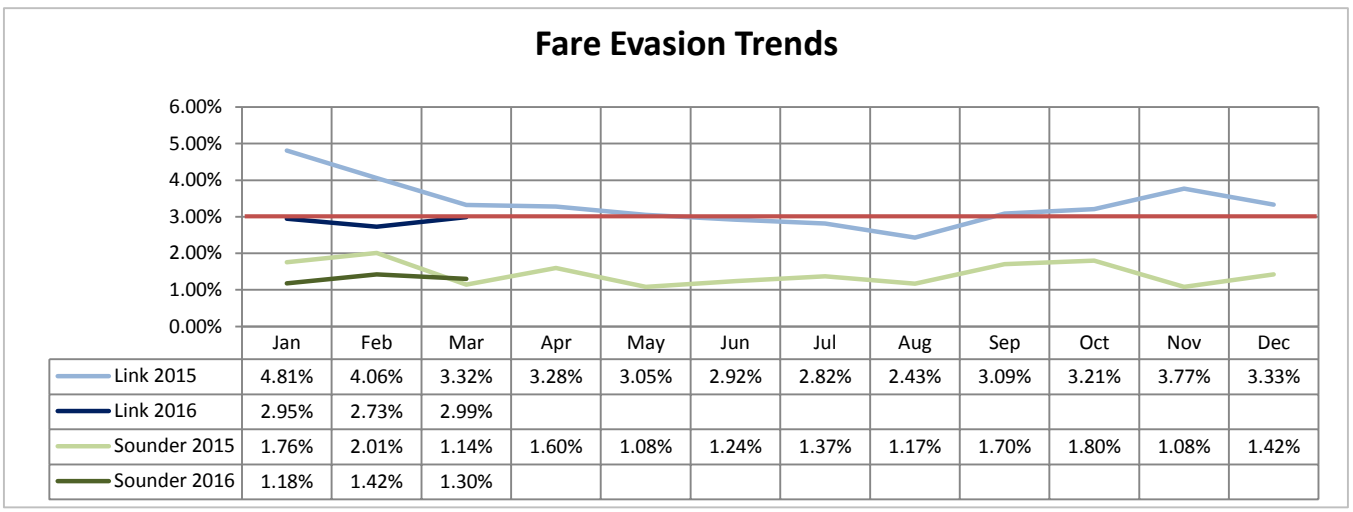


System-wide Permanent & Leased Parking March 2016			
Region	**Available**	**Utilized**	**% Utilized**
Snohomish	3,613	3,120	86%
North King	156	140	90%
East King	1,488	1,477	99%
South King	3,927	3,879	99%
Pierce	4,921	4,385	89%
System Total	**14,105**	**13,001**	**92%**

A total of 14,105 parking stalls are available at 31 locations in Pierce County, Snohomish County, as well as South, East, and North King County. Temporary (leased) parking is available in all regions except East King County.

Utilization continues to be at or near capacity at many of our parking facilities. Overall utilization increased by 2% compared to March 2015, reflecting 92% system-wide utilization.

Snohomish and South King regions posted increases of 7% and 1%, respectively, while the North King and East King saw decreases of 9% and 1%, respectively. Pierce County parking utilization was unchanged compared to March 2015.



	Jan	Feb	Mar	Apr	May	Jun	Jul	Aug	Sep	Oct	Nov	Dec
Link 2015	4.81%	4.06%	3.32%	3.28%	3.05%	2.92%	2.82%	2.43%	3.09%	3.21%	3.77%	3.33%
Link 2016	2.95%	2.73%	2.99%									
Sounder 2015	1.76%	2.01%	1.14%	1.60%	1.08%	1.24%	1.37%	1.17%	1.70%	1.80%	1.08%	1.42%
Sounder 2016	1.18%	1.42%	1.30%									

Fare Evasion on Link improved slightly compared to March 2015, with final results falling within the targeted range at 2.99%. This is significant, considering a 50.4% increase in Link boardings in March 2016 compared to last year.

Sounder fare evasion increased slightly compared to March 2015, with final results of 1.30% for the month. System-wide Sounder boardings increased by about 17.5% in March.

Overall, combined fare evasion improved slightly compared to March 2015, for a combined rate of 2.71%. Fare inspections trended just over 7% of all rail passengers in March 2016.

Sound Transit Operations

2016 Monthly Modal Performance Data Sheet

Month End Reporting	Total Trips Operated (Scheduled & Extra)	Percentage of Scheduled Trips Operated	Scheduled PMIs Completed on Time [1]	Fleet Availability	On-Time Performance [2]	Ridership	Passengers per Trip	Complaints Received	Complaints per 100,000 Boardings	Preventable Accidents [4]	Preventable Accidents per 100,000 Miles (Rolling 12 Months) [5]	Farebox Recovery [6]
ST Express												
Targets	466,000	99.8%	>90.0%	80%	>85.0%	19,500,000	41.8		<15.0		<.80	28.4%
Jan	37,644	99.9%	97.0%	95.7%	84.4%	1,433,007	38.1	237	16.5	9	0.80	32.7%
Feb	36,673	99.9%	92.0%	95.9%	83.9%	1,451,138	39.6	205	14.1	13	0.85	30.6%
Mar	41,910	99.9%	92.0%	95.8%	81.5%	1,581,793	43.1	264	16.7	14	0.89	33.9%
Apr												
May												
Jun												
Jul												
Aug												
Sep												
Oct												
Nov												
Dec												
YTD	116,227	99.9%	93.7%	95.8%	83.3%	4,465,938	38.4	706	15.8	36	0.85	32.4%
Sounder												
Targets	7,362	99.5%	>90.0%	82.0%	>95.0%	3,730,000	507.0		<15.0		<1.00	25.3%
Jan	546	97.5%	100%	86.6%	94.3%	331,257	606.7	29	8.8	0	0.00	31.6%
Feb	586	99.7%	100%	86.2%	95.7%	340,008	580.2	22	6.5	0	0.00	31.5%
Mar	608	93.3%	100%	86.1%	94.4%	365,505	601.2	32	8.8	0	0.00	31.3%
Apr												
May												
Jun												
Jul												
Aug												
Sep												
Oct												
Nov												
Dec												
YTD	1,740	96.8%	100%	86.3%	94.8%	1,036,770	595.8	83	8.0	0	0.00	31.5%

Month End Reporting	Total Trips Operated (Scheduled & Extra)	Percentage of Scheduled Trips Operated	Scheduled PMIs Completed on Time [1]	Fleet Availability	On-Time Performance [2]	Headway Performance +-3 Minutes [3]	Ridership	Passengers per Trip	Complaints Received	Complaints per 100,000 Boardings	Preventable Accidents [4]	Preventable Accidents per 100,000 Miles (Rolling 12 Months) [5]	Farebox Recovery [6]
Tacoma Link													
Targets	49,481	98.5%	>90.0%	66.7%	>98.5%	N/A	950,000	19.2		<15.0		<1.66	N/A
Jan	3,940	100%	100%	98.9%	100%	N/A	75,121	19.1	0	0.0	0	0.00	N/A
Feb	3,921	99.8%	100%	98.9%	99.8%	N/A	86,616	22.1	0	0.0	0	0.00	N/A
Mar	4,269	99.4%	100%	100%	99.4%	N/A	82,631	19.4	1	1.2	0	0.00	N/A
Apr													
May													
Jun													
Jul													
Aug													
Sep													
Oct													
Nov													
Dec													
YTD	12,130	99.7%	100%	99.3%	99.7%	N/A	244,368	20.1	1	0.4	0	0.00	N/A
Central Link													
Targets	100,664	98.5%	>90.0%	86.0%	90.0%	90.00%	17,200,000	171		<15.0		<.30	28.5%
Jan	8,298	98.7%	96.3%	81.3%	94.0%	98.8%	908,411	109.5	18	2.0	0	0.00	27.6%
Feb	8,149	98.1%	95.0%	82.8%	93.2%	98.8%	904,266	111.0	11	1.2	0	0.00	28.5%
Mar	8,602	97.4%	94.3%	86.3%	88.9%	97.9%	1,259,454	146.4	50	4.0	0	0.00	25.5%
Apr													
May													
Jun													
Jul													
Aug													
Sep													
Oct													
Nov													
Dec													
YTD	25,049	98.1%	95.2%	83.4%	92.0%	98.5%	3,072,131	122.6	79	2.6	0	0.00	27.2%

[1] PMIs are preventive vehicle maintenance inspections. Central Link PMIs include Signals, Traction Power, LRV, Track, SCADA, and Facilities.

[2] Actual performance compared to the Budget standard-ST Express: >85%, Sounder: >95%, Central Link: >90%, Tacoma Link: >98.5%.

[3] Headways are scheduled intervals between trips.

[4] An accident in which the operating employee(s) failed to do everything reasonable to prevent the accident.

[5] YTD Preventable accidents per 100,000 miles is based on a rolling 12-month period of data.

[6] Farebox recovery is calculated as farebox revenues divided by total modal operating expenses.

Sound Transit Union Station 401 S. Jackson St., Seattle, WA 98104
1-800-201-4900 TTY Relay: 711 main@soundtransit.org www.soundtransit.org